

Visual T'filah

Help create our Shabbat together

During an upcoming Friday night, our prayers will be carried by images on the screen, and I would love for some of them to come from you. Spend a few quiet minutes with one prayer, listen for what it stirs in you, and then capture or create an image that holds that feeling. Here is a way to begin.

My prayer is: _____

REFLECT

Its main themes, ideas, and emotions are:

Picking your own?

Choose a prayer that moves you, puzzles you, or that you would love to see in a fresh way.

IMAGINE

When I close my eyes and picture this prayer, I see:

Any form works

Photo

a wide view, a few objects, people

Video

a slow pan, slow motion

Artwork

a painting, sculpture, or collage (photograph it)

Movement

dance or gesture, on video

Digital art

your own illustration or animation

Be creative. The image only needs to open a door into the prayer.

BRAINSTORM

I could find or create this image by:

Thinking thematically

Ask: What is this prayer really about? What season or moment does it touch? Should the picture be literal, like candles for the candle blessing, or a feeling, like warmth and gathering light? What mood do you want our sanctuary to hold when this prayer is sung?

please continue →

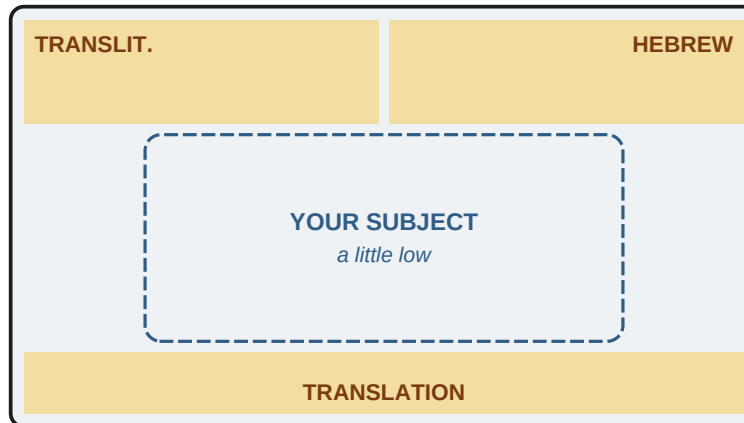
rabbi.dan@medw.in • techrabbi.org

Leaving room for the words

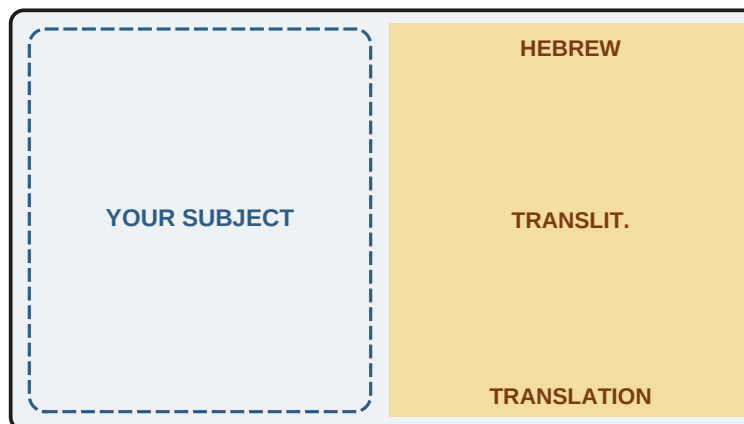
How to frame your image so the prayer has a place to live

Your image becomes the background, and the prayer's words rest on top of it: Hebrew in the upper right, transliteration in the upper left, translation along the bottom. Keep those areas calm and open so the words are never lost.

Option 1: words around the edges



Option 2: words down one side



Amber stays calm for the words. Dashed is room for your subject. Either half can hold the words.

A few framing tips

- Shoot wide and horizontal, and leave breathing room instead of cropping tight.
- Keep the calm zones plain: open sky, a wall, water, or a soft blur.
- Place your subject off to one side, or low and center, not filling the frame.
- Simpler is stronger: a quiet background reads better behind text than a busy one.
- Take several shots from a few angles, at the highest resolution you can.

When you are ready, email your images to rabbi.dan@medw.in, and tell me which prayer each one is for. Thank you for helping our prayers come alive.